

Board 1

East Deals

None Vul

♠ J 9 4
♥ A 4
♦ Q 8 6 5
♣ A 8 7 3

♠ 7 3
♥ J T 9 7 6 3
♦ K 3
♣ 5 4 2



♠ A T 8 5 2
♥ K 8 2
♦ T 9 2
♣ Q J

♠ K Q 6
♥ Q 5
♦ A J 7 4
♣ K T 9 6

West

North

East

South

Pass

2♥

Pass

1NT

All Pass

2♥ by North

The bidding has been as shown.

Surprise - you open 1NT. Partner responds 2♥. (no transfers in this lesson)

Pass. Partner has long ♥s (probably 6) and short points (fewer than 9). He has decided that 2♥ will be a better spot than 1NT. Trust him.

Board 2

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 7 4 3
 ♥ A 8 6 4
 ♦ K T 8
 ♣ J 8 4

♠ J 8
 ♥ Q J T 7 3
 ♦ J 5 3
 ♣ A 7 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A T 9 5 2
 ♥ 9 2
 ♦ 9 6 2
 ♣ Q 5 2

♠ K Q 6
 ♥ K 5
 ♦ A Q 7 4
 ♣ K T 9 6

West	North	East	South
Pass	Pass	Pass	1NT
Pass	3♥	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			

The bidding has been as shown.

You open 1NT and partner replies 3♥. What do you say next?

With this bidding method, partner's bid shows at least 10 points and exactly 5 ♥s. He expects you to choose between 3NT and 4♥. Since you have just a doubleton in ♥s you choose 3NT.

NOTE: Jacoby Transfers are very useful for this type of hand.

Board 3

West Deals

None Vul

♠ A 8 5 2

♥ J 9 6 4

♦ 9 8 5

♣ Q 8

♠ J T 9 7 3

♥ A 8 2

♦ 6 2

♣ A 7 5



♠ 4

♥ Q T 7 3

♦ K J T 3

♣ J 4 3 2

♠ K Q 6

♥ K 5

♦ A Q 7 4

♣ K T 9 6

West

Pass

Pass

All Pass

4♠ by North

North

Pass

3♠

East

Pass

Pass

South

1NT

4♠

The bidding has been as shown.

Yes this is exactly the same hand you held in Deal 8. You still open 1NT. This time partner responds 3♠.

Partner shows 10+ points and exactly 5 ♠s. This time, with 3-card support, you choose game in ♠s, knowing there is an 8-card fit.

Board 4

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 7 4
♥ T 7 5 2
♦ 9 6 5
♣ A 5 4 3

♠ A T 9

♥ 8 3

♦ A K J T 8 2

♣ J 8



♠ J 8 5 3 2

♥ A J 9 6

♦ 3

♣ Q 7 2

♠ K Q 6

♥ K Q 4

♦ Q 7 4

♣ K T 9 6

The bidding has been as shown.

You open 1NT and partner says 3♦. It's your bid.

Partner has a great hand. A jump to 3 in a Minor suit almost always shows slam interest. But that's partner with interest, not you. You couldn't have a more minimum 1NT opening bid.

So you just return to 3NT. Partner gives up and passes.

West	North	East	South
		Pass	1NT
Pass	3♦	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			

Board 5

East Deals

None Vul

♠ J T 4 2

♥ J 9 3 2

♦ Q 9 6

♣ J 3

♠ 3

♥ A 8 5

♦ K J 3

♣ A Q 8 7 5 4



♠ A 9 8 7 5

♥ T 7 6

♦ T 8 5 2

♣ 2

♠ K Q 6

♥ K Q 4

♦ A 7 4

♣ K T 9 6

The bidding has been as shown.

You open 1NT and partner responds 3♣. What is your next bid?

Partner's jump to 3♣ shows at least 5 ♣s and slam interest. Your hand is good enough to encourage that interest so you bypass 3NT and say 4♣. Partner now bids 4NT. What do you answer?

That is Blackwood. You admit to one Ace and partner bids 6♣.

West	North	East	South
		Pass	1NT
Pass	3♣	Pass	4♣
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♦
Pass	6♣		
All Pass			
6♣ by North			

Board 6

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 7 5 2
 ♥ 5
 ♦ K 9 8 7 5
 ♣ A 7 2

♠ K 9 6
 ♥ K J 6 4
 ♦ A Q 4
 ♣ Q J 5



♠ J T 4 3
 ♥ A T
 ♦ J T 3 2
 ♣ K 8 4

♠ Q 8
 ♥ Q 9 8 7 3 2
 ♦ 6
 ♣ T 9 6 3

West	North	East	South
1 ♦	1NT	Pass	2 ♥
All Pass			
2 ♥ by South			

The bidding has been as shown.

A 1NT overcall is almost the same as a 1NT opening. The range is increased to 15-18, but the main difference is that you **must** have the opponent's suit adequately stopped. Here you certainly have the stopper so you bid 1NT. Partner responds 2 ♥.

And the responses are the same also. Partner's 2 ♥ bid is a signoff bid, often called a "drop dead" bid. So even though you really like the ♥s you pass.